

can't cash it in without a penalty for twenty years, but the bank can call the CD at any time.

If interest rates have risen since the CD was issued, the bank will keep the CD in force because the rate will be below the current market rates. If interest rates have fallen, the bank will call the CD so it doesn't have to pay you above-market rates. This leaves you with money to invest at low rates when you may have thought you were locked in at a higher rate for a longer period. An excellent website to compare all types of bank rates is www.bankrate.com.